Disclaimer

- This video is based entirely on publicly available data from the 2021 and 2026 Tamil Nadu election datasets.
- Any reference to political parties, individuals, or communities is purely for analytical purposes. I do not support or oppose any party, religion, caste, or individual.
- To adhere to the mentioned guidelines, this presentation contains no pictures of political leaders or party symbols.
- Furthermore, this analysis relies solely on objective data. It does not attempt to explain why any party won or lost, nor does it make any predictions about the future. This project has been created with the full understanding that breaking the strict neutrality rule will result in immediate disqualification, regardless of the overall quality of the work.
- If anything in this presentation has come across as unintentionally incorrect or insensitive, I sincerely apologize — this is an amateur data project made with good intent.

ATLIQ MEDIA | DATA-ONLY ANALYSIS

Decoding the 2026 Tamil Nadu Assembly Election

A fact-based analysis for AtliQ's one-hour TV show
Source: Election Commission of India | Non-partisan | ECI data only

The Turnout story

The Flip story

The margin of victory story

234 constituencies | Tamil Nadu | May 2026

Tools used:

List of Tools:

- Google Colab – For Analysis and Visualization
- Streamlit – Dashboard
- Powerpoint – Slide deck
- AI tools - Gemini and Claude

Three Findings. One Story.

Record participation → historic churn → fragmented results

86.2%

Avg. Turnout 2026

Tamil Nadu's highest ever recorded turnout — up 12.8 percentage points from 73.4% in 2021.

Chapter 1: The Turnout Record

163 / 234

Seats Changed Hands

7 in every 10 constituencies returned a different winning party compared to 2021.

Chapter 2: The Seat Flip

48% → 37%

Median Win Vote Share

Winners needed less than ever — 64 seats were won with under 35% of valid votes.

Chapter 3: The Margin Shift

Source: Election Commission of India | Non-partisan. No causal claims.

CHAPTER 1

The Turnout Record

86.2%

Turnout 2026

+12.8pp

vs 2021

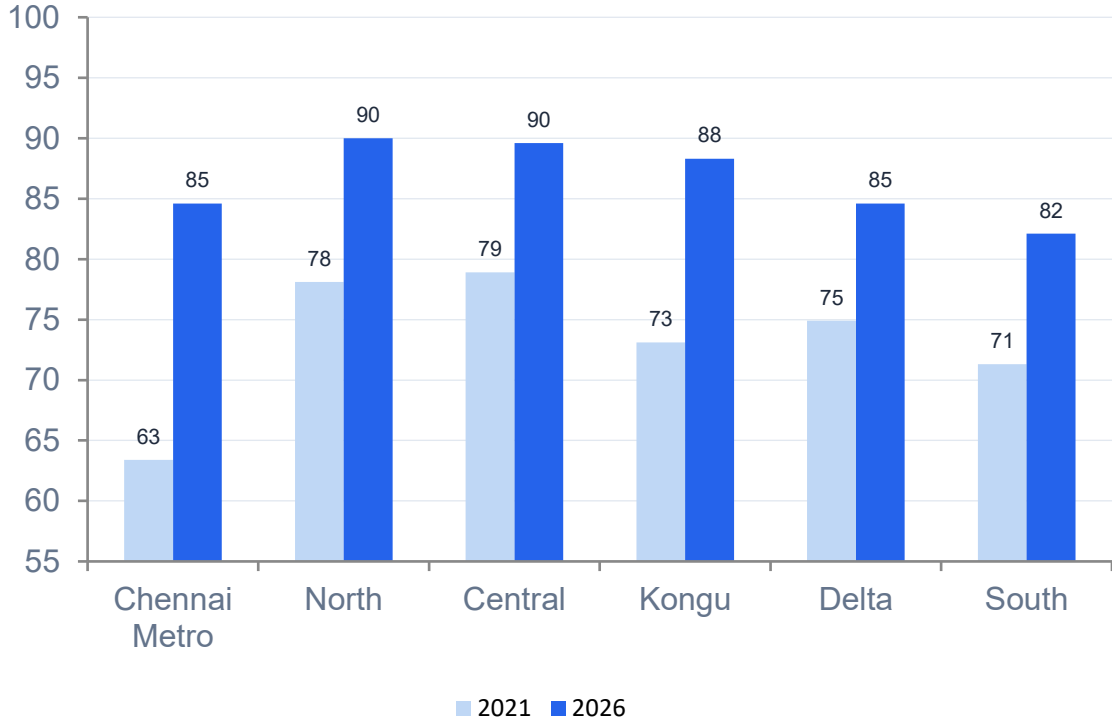
146 / 234

Seats above 85%

Only 5 of 234 constituencies exceeded 85% turnout in 2021. In 2026, 146 did.

Where Did Turnout Rise Most?

Average turnout by region — 2021 vs 2026



+21.2 pp

Chennai Metro
largest regional jump

17 of 20

Top-jump constituencies
are in Chennai Metro
or Kongu

Source: elections.tn.gov.in (April 2026 electoral roll) + ECI results portal

CHAPTER 2

The Seat Flip

163

Seats changed hands

70%

Of all 234 seats

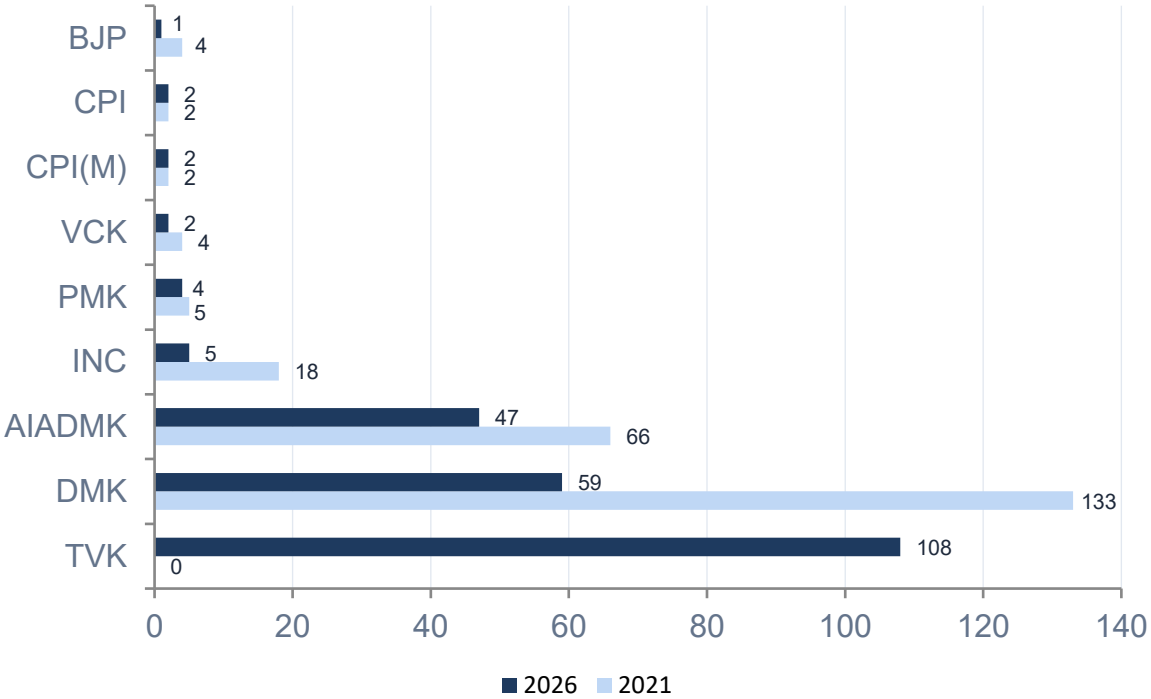
71

Seats held (30%)

The largest single flow: 65 seats moved from one party to another — the dominant pattern in this data.

How Did Seat Counts Change?

Seats won per party — 2021 vs 2026 | Sankey diagram available in the interactive dashboard



Flow	Seats
Held by same party	71
Largest single flow	65
Total seats changed	163
Total constituencies	234

Note: Party names as recorded by ECI. Alliance groupings not reflected.

CHAPTER 3

The Margin Shift

48% → 37%

Median win share

64

Seats won below 35%

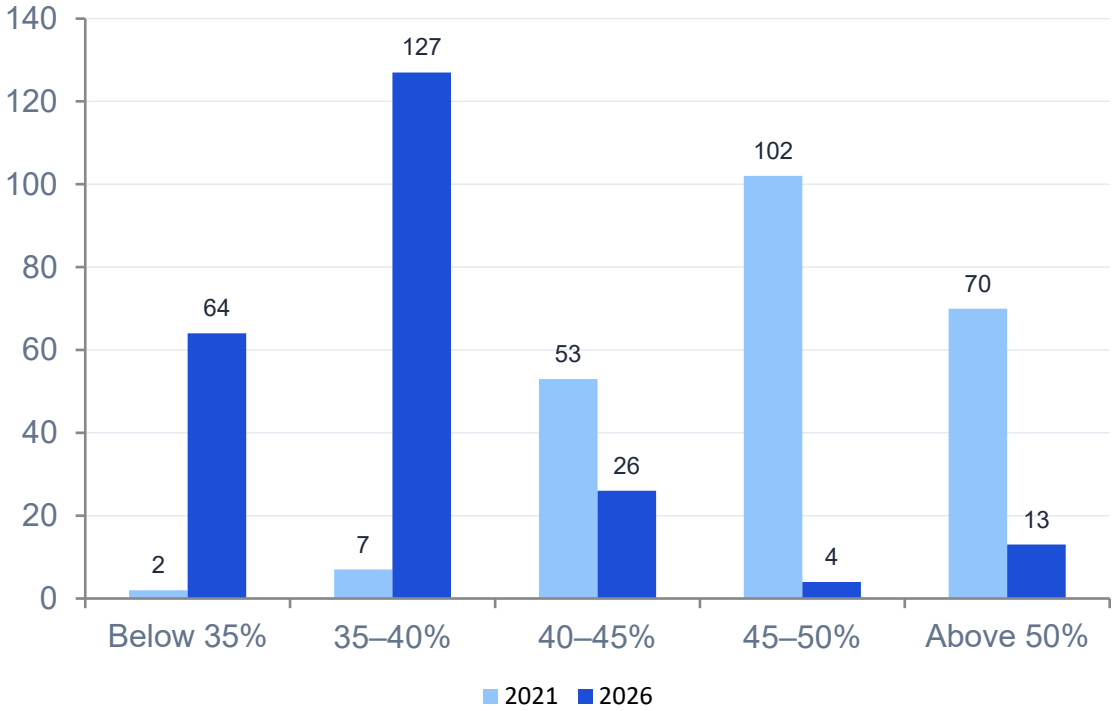
70 → 13

Seats won above 50%

Despite record voter participation, winners secured a smaller share of valid votes than in 2021.

Winners Won With Less — Not More

Distribution of winning vote share — 2021 vs 2026



Metric	2021	2026
Avg margin (votes)	22,871	16,784
Median vote share	48.2%	37.4%
Winners above 50%	70	13
Winners below 35%	2	64
Highest share	72.1%	58.9%
Lowest share	33.5%	29.3%

The shift in distribution from 45–50% band (2021) to 35–40% band (2026) is the defining visual.

EDITORIAL RECOMMENDATION

01 Open with the Turnout Record

Lead with 86.2%. One number. No context needed. Every viewer understands participation — it sets the stakes without any political framing.

02 Centrepiece: The Seat Flow Sankey

Dedicate 20 minutes to the Sankey. Walk through constituency-by-constituency flows. Highest visual impact. Stays purely factual. Sparks discussion without editorialising.

03 Close with the Margin Story

End with the 48% → 37% shift. Counter-intuitive (more voters, but winners won with less share).

Data Sources & Limitations

What this analysis can and cannot tell you

DATA SOURCES

ECI Results Portal (2026)

results.eci.gov.in/ResultAcGenMay2026

Chief Electoral Officer, Tamil Nadu

elections.tn.gov.in — April 2026 electoral roll

Codebasics Starter Pack

tn_2021_results.csv, tn_2026_results.csv, constituency_master.csv

ECI Statistical Reports

eci.gov.in/statistical-reports (2021 cross-check)

LIMITATIONS

Turnout denominator

2026 electors from April 2026 roll. ECI Form-20 final audited data not yet released. Minor variations possible.

No alliance-level data

Parties analysed individually. Vote transfer between allied parties cannot be determined from ECI candidate-level data.

No causal claims

This analysis describes what the data shows. It does not explain why turnout rose, why seats changed, or why margins shifted.

2021 electors back-calculated

Derived from original turnout percentage. May carry rounding from the ECI source figure.

Disclaimer: This is a non-partisan data exercise. Codebasics does not endorse, criticise, or take any political position on parties, leaders, or outcomes.

THANK YOU